

19

WHO KNEW THAT THE “19” that all of us would be talking about in 2020 would be a virus (COVID-19) not our own anniversary (DIGIT-19)! The world is a rather weird place at the moment, and there is so much going on that we decided that to hell with the darn virus, we’re going to go ahead and celebrate our anniversary.

It’s not easy though. While the world is shut down, people are suffering, lives and livelihoods are being lost, fear and depression rages... it feels very, very weird to be celebrating anything. We’re certainly not trying to ignore or play down all of the bad, we’re just trying to focus on some good things for a change.

Digit has always felt more like a family-run business than anything else – where not just the owners or directors get a say, but everyone from the company, our clients and our readers, are all in this together, doing this for the love of all things tech. However, as with all businesses across the globe right now, the situation is dire because of lockdowns. The real test of character of a company is how it treats its customers, and its employees. A business is just an extension of the people who run it, and those who work there. As we know, the real mark of a person is how s/he behaves when times are tough.

People often ask me why I love working at Digit. Why have I stayed here for so many years, even after moving to a different country? Digit’s reaction to this latest crisis spells out the reason why.

As soon as it became painfully obvious that the situation was dire and that business was going to be affected badly, our directors immediately told all of us in senior management that they would be taking a 100% pay cut until things got better. A collective decision was made to comfort every employee, and assure them not one single person would be fired, there would be no delayed salaries, and there was no need to worry about anything. The only ask was that every employee also pass on the love, and not cut the salary of anyone who worked for them at home – maids, drivers, servants, anyone. I am actually breaking the trust of my bosses by informing you of their actions, because they did not do this for praise, even if they deserve far more praise than I can offer.

Next, it was decided that Digit will, as always, never shortchange our customers. Our readers should get more than what they pay for, but never less. We launched the digital version of

the magazine, almost overnight, by working from all corners of India and the world to ensure that our readers got to read their favourite magazine, and got something good and positive to do during these tough times.

Many publications across the world offered up vanilla PDFs, and asked subscribers to make do with it. We didn’t pass on the helplessness of the situation to you, even though we know you, our beloved reader, would accept the digital issue as part of their subscription, given the helplessness of the situation for everyone involved. There’s a reason insurance companies don’t cover what they call “Acts of God”, giving themselves a loophole to get out of their commitment in such situations. However, even acts of gods cannot come between us and our readers!

Our subscribers will get exactly the amount of print issues as they paid for, and subscriptions will be extended for the two months we did not print physical magazines. For you, dear subscriber, the two months of digital magazines that we made in April and May are just a free bonus!

For those of you who buy Digit every month... please subscribe! Not only do you save money and get the magazine home delivered, you get covered by what we like to think of as the Digit Family Guarantee – as explained above. If you can afford it, we’d really appreciate you committing to our magazine and buying that subscription.

In addition to the anniversary issue package that you hold in your hand, we’re also launching SKOAR! Digital, which will be put up on sale on <https://geek.digit.in/shop/> around the 15th of every month (“When it’s done!” remember?). We’re giving every buyer of Digit’s 19th Anniversary issue, and every subscriber of Digit free access to the first issue of SKOAR! Digital. If you are a subscriber, you will already have access added to your account on geek.digit.in and if you are a buyer of the anniversary issue from newsstands, you can get access by writing in to us at editor@digit.in and we will give you the requisite access.

We hope you enjoy reading this awesome package you have got your hands on, because Team Digit killed itself making it. We look forward to celebrating many more anniversaries with you. Stay safe, stay healthy, stay happy. We love you all! 🇮🇳



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